ECON 308
Banking and Monetary Policy
Spring 2026
Section 10: MoWeFr 11:30AM - 12:25PM
Smith Hall Room 130

Instructor Information and Office Hours

Instructor Information
Frank Gentile
Pronouns: he, him, his
Preferred salutation: Frank
Email: fgentile@udel.edu
Office: 333G Purnell

Student Hours
In-person: Mondays & Fridays 8:30-9:30am in my office.
Virtual: Tuesdays 2:00-3:00 pm via Zoom. Link here
Other times by appointment. Email to set up.

What are student hours? Student hours (also called office hours) are a dedicated time during the week for students to ask questions or engage in discussion about course content with their faculty member, TA, or other learning assistant. There will be a total of 3 student hours per week offered this semester.

Course Overview
Description: Nature and economic significance of money, credit and the banking system; the origin and management of the money supply; and effects of monetary changes on price levels, output and employment.

Prerequisites: Introduction to Macroeconomics, ECON103, or equivalent.

Learning Outcomes

After successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Explain how financial systems are organized and identify their key functions and purposes, including the reasons for their inherent vulnerabilities.
2. Evaluate the vulnerabilities within financial systems and describe how and why countries regulate the financial sector to mitigate these risks.
3. Describe the functions of central banks, including how they manage monetary policy and financial stability, and the tools they use to achieve their objectives.
4. Analyze the key challenges central banks encounter in their operations and the strategies they employ to address these challenges.
5. Explain the process by which monetary policy is transmitted to the economy and its impact on key economic indicators.
6. Assess the effectiveness of monetary policy and financial regulation in achieving economic stability and growth.

Course Materials

Required Textbook
Money, Banking, and Financial Markets by Stephen G. Cecchetti and Kermit L. Schoenholtz. Cost: $101.40.

Textbook Provided via Digital Delivery Program
This course will participate in the "Digital Delivery" program through the bookstore. You will receive an automatic charge on your University Account after the add/drop date for the discounted cost of $**101.40**. If you opt out of Digital Delivery or drop the class before the add/drop date, you will not receive a charge on your University Account, and your access to the course resources will be deactivated. Please contact the UD bookstore for details on how to opt out of Digital Delivery.

Required Technology

Canvas: In this class, Canvas, UD's online learning management system, will be used for all course activities and communication channels. All assignments will be posted through the Canvas course site unless otherwise directed. Information on how to use Canvas is available through the Canvas Student Guide. Canvas can also be accessed via MyUD.

Poll Everywhere: We will use this online polling platform to collect real-time responses from everyone attending class. Access to Poll Everywhere is possible by using any computer or mobile device with internet access. Poll Everywhere is a UD licensed tool and there is no cost to you to use this tool. Please read over the UD student guide that will demonstrate how to log in and how to respond to polls. As a reminder, the UD academic honesty policy applies to the use of educational technology tools such as Poll Everywhere.

Zoom: In this class, Zoom will be used for video conferencing. You will receive a meeting invitation with a specific web link and meeting ID number for use in this class. Zoom is a web-based application that can be used from a computer, tablet, or phone. From a computer, click the class web link and be sure to install the small program that will download to your computer. You only need to install the program once. From a mobile device, download the free Zoom app and type in the class meeting ID number. A microphone and camera are recommended for online meetings. Information on how to test your computer's audio and video can be found on Zoom's website. Learn more info about Zoom at UD.

Learning Assignments & Assessments

Course Grading
The final course grade will be calculated using the following components:

Course Component	Percentage of Total
Homework via Connect	15%
Class Engagement	15%
Quiz #1	15%
Quiz #2	15%
Quiz #3	15%
Final Exam	25%
TOTAL	**100%**

Grading Scale
Students will be assigned the following letter grade based on the calculation coming from the course assessment section as follows (letter and associated total points):

A Range		B Range		C Range		D Range		F Range	
A	93 - 100	B+	87 - 90	C+	77 - 80	D+	67 - 70	F	59 or less
A-	90 - 93	B	83 - 87	C	73 - 77	D	63 - 67		
		B-	80 - 83	C-	70 - 73	D-	60 - 63		

Exams (70% of course grade)

There are three non-cumulative quizzes **given during class** followed by a cumulative final exam given during finals week. Quizzes will consist of multiple-choice questions, while the final will consist of multiple choice, short answer, and graphing questions.

Every student is expected to take all exams. In the event of exam conflicts, please contact the instructor. You must take the final exam (Exam 3) at the scheduled date and time. Dates and content covered are as follows:

- Quiz 1, March 4th Chapters 2-6
- Quiz 2, April 8th, Chapters 7, 11, 14-16
- Quiz 3 May 6th, Chapters 18, 20-22

Our third and final exam will be given during the final exam period as follows:

- Exam 3: May 17th 2:00-4:00 pm in Smith 130. Cumulative.

Class Engagement (15% of course grade)

You will be able to earn up to 10 points per week by actively participating in class, completing checks for understanding, and following the classroom/course policies. This will mainly be comprised of PollEverywhere questions, with half a

point coming from answering the question and half a point for correctness. It will also include participation in in-class activities, as well as a two-minute conversation with Frank.

A two-minute conversation with Frank: This assignment is intended to encourage you to talk with the instructor, and to help me learn a bit about you. The conversation can be about anything. Suggested topics include course content, economics news, or your career. It can also be on topics outside of the classroom- I'm an avid follower of the NBA and NFL, I enjoy traveling, cooking, and reading fiction. The only parameters for this assignment are that it lasts at least two minutes, and it occurs outside of class (ideally in office hours, but also if you see me around on campus). This assignment will be worth 10 points to your class engagement category.

Suggestion Boxes: I will be soliciting written feedback semi-regularly in class. This is your opportunity to make suggestions, ask questions, or provide other feedback via pencil and paper. You may choose to give this feedback anonymously or not.

Homework (HW) (15% of course grade)

There will be twelve online homework assignments using McGrawHill Connect (our textbook publisher's online homework system). Each Connect homework will consist of a varying quantity of multiple-choice or short analysis questions and you will have two attempts to answer each question correctly. Homework assignments are due by midnight of the following Monday each week. Please see the course schedule for due dates. If you miss an assignment, you may complete it by reading day with a 50% penalty.

SmartBook Adaptive Questions

SmartBook is a self-study quizzing program for students that quickly adapts to what students know and helps them practice what they don't yet understand. Once students demonstrate that they understand a concept, the related questions will no longer appear. If students continue to struggle with a concept, they are more likely to encounter repeating questions, or will be forced to read the section on that chapter.

I strongly suggest you complete these each week before coming to class, but when (and if) you complete them is entirely up to you.

Getting Help
If you feel like you need additional help on a topic, here are some places to go:

- Frank. Come to my student hours! This time is set aside for you, and I would love to speak with you in-person or virtually.
- Department tutoring sessions: TBD. I will post an announcement on Canvas with instructions for signing up with the information that become available.
- UD Office of Academic Enrichment offers several tutoring options (drop in, virtual, group, one-on-one): https://www.ae.udel.edu/tutoring-services/

Course Communication
During the semester, I will be communicating with you through Canvas Announcements. You should turn on your notifications on Canvas so that you receive communication in a timely fashion. Additionally, it is prudent to log into Canvas at least once a day to make sure you are updated with work that has been assigned.

Email Communication (fgentile@udel.edu)
On non-class days, I prefer email communication (i.e. **not through Canvas inbox**). To facilitate communication, the university requires you to have an e-mail account ending in @udel.edu which should be used to communicate with me.

On class days, I prefer in-person communication. Please speak to me before or after class or in my office. In-person explanations are often better than email. I try to hold myself accountable to respond to emails within 24 hours

Use of Tobacco + Marijuana Products

The use of tobacco and marijuana products, smokeless or otherwise, is strictly prohibited in class. Further, those posing a negative externality on others in the form of bad odors on their clothing will be asked to leave the classroom.

Classroom Behavior Policy

To foster a positive learning environment, students and instructors have a shared responsibility. We want a safe, welcoming, and inclusive environment where all of us feel comfortable with each other and where we can challenge ourselves to succeed. To that end, our focus is on the tasks at hand and not on extraneous activities (e.g., texting, chatting, reading a newspaper, making phone calls, web surfing, etc.). Cellphones must be on silent mode and not visible to the Instructor unless conducting a clicker activity.

I want you all to help and communicate with each other. However, the class delivery format is a lecture, and so please try to keep side conversations to a minimum. Students observed engaging in disruptive activity will be asked to cease this behavior. Those who continue to disrupt the class will be asked to leave class and may be reported to the Dean of Students.

Attendance Policy

Students are expected to attend all scheduled class sessions. Students should arrive on time for class. Arriving late is disruptive to both the instructor and your fellow students.

If a student cannot attend class due to unavoidable circumstances, it is the student's responsibility to inform the instructor ahead of time. In the event of illness, family emergencies, or religious observances will be excused, provided that appropriate documentation is provided. Students may be asked to complete additional assignments or in class activities in the event of extended absences.

> Religious Holidays, Athletic, & Extracurricular Absences
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> Absences on religious holidays listed in university calendars are recognized as an excused absence. Nevertheless, students are urged to remind the instructor of their intention to be absent on a particular upcoming holiday. Absences on religious holidays not listed in university calendars, as well as absences due to athletic participation or other extracurricular activities in which students are official representatives of the university, shall be recognized as excused absences when the student informs the instructor in writing during the **first two weeks** of the semester of these planned absences for the semester. **Students must provide class DATES they will miss to be excused.**

Recording and Distribution of Recordings of Class Sessions

Our course content is intended for educational use within our classroom community only. Recording, taking screen shots, **photographs of slides**, or distributing class Zoom sessions (if applicable) in any manner is not allowed except in cases of an approved accommodation from the Office of Disability Support Services (DSS).

Distribution of Class Materials

Selling, giving class notes, and/or other course materials to others not currently enrolled in this course with your instructor, or to a third party for resale, is not permitted. Violations of this and other course rules may result in course sanctions.

Use of Automated Tools

Students are allowed to use AI tools in the course. It is important for students to learn how to use this technology, and what it can and cannot do. However, each student is responsible for ensuring the accuracy of the output of these tools. In the event of conflicts between the textbook and the information given from AI tools, we will use the textbook as ground truth.

Notification of Objectionable Materials

This course may contain material of a mature nature, which may include explicit language, depictions of nudity, sexual situations, and/or violence. The instructor will provide advance notice when such materials will be used. Students are not

automatically excused from interacting with such materials, but they are encouraged to speak with the instructor to voice concerns and to provide feedback.

Student Mental Health & Wellbeing
In addition to impacting your overall well-being, diminished mental health can interfere with optimal academic performance. If this course is causing or contributing significant mental or emotional stress, then please reach out to me directly. However, problems with other parts of your life can also contribute to decreased academic performance. UD's Center for Counseling & Student Development (CCSD) provides cost-free and confidential mental health services to help you manage personal challenges that threaten your emotional or academic well-being. Remember, getting help is a smart and courageous thing to do -- for yourself and for those who care about you.

Contact me if you are struggling with this class, please check-in during office hours or contact me by email at fgentile@udel.edu.

Check-in with your academic advisor if you are struggling in multiple classes, unsure whether you are making the most of your time at UD, or unsure what academic resources are available at UD. Some resources are:

> UD's Center for Counseling & Student Development and UD Helpline
> CCSD is open and available remotely, and 24/7 mental health support remains available on the UD Helpline at 302-831-1001 for any student in need of someone to talk to. Visit CCSD's website for additional information and resources.
> UD's Crisis Text Line
>
> Text "UDTEXT" or "STEVE" at 741741 connect with a professional who specializes in supporting students of color via a confidential text message.
>
> Division of Student Life
> Explore the Student Life's Wellbeing webpage for a comprehensive listing of well-being resources, activities and services available to all students.

Lerner College of Business and Economics Diversity Statement
At Lerner College of Business and Economics, we celebrate diversity, amplify voices, and promote understanding and belonging through open dialogue, impactful initiatives, and engaging programs. In our classroom, we value human diversity in all its richly complex and multi-faceted forms – expressed through race and ethnicity, culture, political and social views, religious and spiritual beliefs, language and geographic characteristics, gender, gender identities, and sexual orientations, learning and physical abilities, age, and social or economic classes. Should you encounter any concerns or issues, particularly related to inclusivity or discrimination, we encourage you to reach out to Dr. Yetter, the Office of Equity and Inclusion, and/or the Dean of Students for support and resolution.

Discover more about our upcoming events by visiting the LDC Events page and take the step to pledge your commitment to diversity and inclusion by signing the Lerner Promise. For more information and/or to volunteer, please contact Professor Anu Sivaraman (anusiva@udel.edu).

UD Academic Policies

The Safety of Our Learning Environment

Student learning can only occur when students and their instructors feel safe, respected, and supported by each other. To ensure that our learning environment is as safe as possible, you are expected to abide by the most up-to-date University of Delaware's COVID-19 Guidelines.

Academic Integrity

Please familiarize yourself with UD policies regarding academic dishonesty. To falsify the results of one's research, to steal the words or ideas of another, to cheat on an assignment, to re-submit the same assignment for different classes, or to allow or assist another to commit these acts corrupts the educational process. Students are expected to do their own work and neither give nor receive unauthorized assistance. View the university's academic integrity policies and procedures. Office of Student Conduct, 218 Hullihen Hall, (302) 831-2117. E-mail: student-conduct@udel.edu

Harassment, Discrimination, and Sexual Misconduct

Lauren's Promise- I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening you.

Lauren McClusky, a 21-year-old honors student athlete, was murdered on October 22, 2018 by a man she briefly dated on the University of Utah campus. ***We must all take actions to ensure that this never happens again.***

The University of Delaware works to promote an academic and work environment that is free from all forms of discrimination, including harassment and sexual misconduct. As a member of the community, your rights, resource and responsibilities are reflected in the Non-Discrimination, Sexual Misconduct, and Title IX policy. Please familiarize yourself with this policy at the University's Office of Equity & Inclusion's website. You can report any concerns to the University's Office of Equity & Inclusion, at 305 Hullihen Hall, (302) 831-8063 or you can report anonymously through UD Police (302) 831-2222 or the EthicsPoint Compliance Hotline.

- Read the full policy
- File a report

Faculty Statement on Disclosures of Instances of Sexual Misconduct

If, at any time during this course, I happen to be made aware that a student may have been the victim of sexual misconduct (including sexual harassment, sexual violence, domestic/dating violence, or stalking), I am obligated by federal law to inform the university's Title IX Coordinator. The university needs to know information about such incidents to, not only offer resources, but to ensure a safe campus environment. The Title IX Coordinator will decide if the incident should be examined further. If such a situation is disclosed to me in class, in a paper assignment, or in office hours, I promise to protect your privacy--I will not disclose the incident to anyone but the Title IX Coordinator.

For more information on Sexual Misconduct policies, where to get help, and reporting information, please refer to www.udel.edu/sexualmisconduct. At UD, we provide 24/7/365 crisis assistance and victim advocacy and counseling. Contact 302-831-1001 to get in touch with a sexual offense support advocate, as well as confidential and anonymous counseling services for other concerns.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

Any student who may need an accommodation based on a disability should contact the Office of Disability Support Services (DSS) office as soon as possible. For more information, please visit Getting Registered at DSS. Contact DSS by phone: 302-831-4643; fax: 302-831-3261; website: www.udel.edu/dss; email: dssoffice@udel.edu; or visit 240 Academy Street, Alison Hall Suite 130 during business hours (8-5 M-F).

Non-Discrimination

The University of Delaware does not discriminate against any person on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, genetic information, marital status, disability, religion, age, veteran status or any other characteristic protected by applicable law in its employment, educational programs and activities, admissions policies, and scholarship and loan programs as required by Title IX of the Educational Amendments of 1972, the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, and other applicable statutes and University policies. The University of Delaware also prohibits unlawful harassment including sexual harassment and sexual violence.

For inquiries or complaints related to non-discrimination policies, please contact: Office of Equity & Inclusion- oei@udel.edu, 305 Hullihen Hall Newark, DE 19716 (302) 831-8063

For complaints related to Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and/or the Americans with Disabilities Act, please contact: Office of Disability Support Services, dssoffice@udel.edu, Alison Hall, Suite 130, Newark, DE 19716 (302) 831-4643 OR contact the U.S. Department of Education - Office for Civil Rights

Tentative Course Calendar

Information contained in the course calendar is subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor.

Week	DOW	Date	Topic & Ch(s)	Reading	Homework
1	M W F	2-Feb 4-Feb 6-Feb	Intro to course + syllabus Intro to Money & Banking	Ch. 2 & 3, "Are stablecoins really the future of payments?"	
2	M W F	9-Feb 11-Feb 13-Feb	Time Value of Money	Ch. 4, "Baseball and the $700 Million Bet on the Time Value of Money"	Homework #1 due
3	M W F	16-Feb 18-Feb 20-Feb	Risk	Ch. 5, "Ergodicity, what's it mean"	Homework #2 due
4	M W F	23-Feb 25-Feb 27-Feb	Bonds and Interest Rates	Ch. 6, "Wall Street's Favorite Recession Indicator Is in a Slump of Its Own"	Homework #3 due
5	M W F	2-Mar 4-Mar 6-Mar	Risk and Interest Rates Quiz #1 (Ch 2-6)	Ch. 7	Homework #4 due
6	M W F	9-Mar 11-Mar 13-Mar	Financial Intermediation	Ch. 11, "What is 'moral hazard' and why does Silicon Valley Bank have us talking about it again?"	Homework #5 due
7	M W F	16-Mar 18-Mar 20-Mar	Regulation	Ch. 14, "How Trump's Ally at the Fed is Remaking Bank Oversight"	Homework #6 due
8	M W F	23-Mar 25-Mar 27-Mar	-spring break- -spring break- -spring break-		
9	M W F	30-Mar 1-Apr 3-Apr	Central Banks	Ch. 15 &16, "Supreme Court Will Decide if Fed Independence Has Any Legal Teeth"	Homework #7 due
10	M W F	6-Apr 8-Apr 10-Apr	Monetary Policy Quiz #2	Ch. 18	Homework #8 due
11	M W F	13-Apr 15-Apr 17-Apr	Monetary Aggregates	Ch. 20, "SVB and the Fed"	Homework #9 due
12	M W F	20-Apr 22-Apr 24-Apr	AD-AS & Monetary Policy	Ch. 21, "Americans hate inflation more than they hate unemployment"	Homework #10 due
13	M W F	27-Apr 29-Apr 1-May	Business Cycle Fluctuations	Ch. 22, "The Fed wants to bring inflation down to 2%. But why not 3%? Or 5%?	Homework #11 due
14	M W	4-May 6-May	Modern Monetary Policy Quiz #3	Ch 23	Homework #12 due

	F	8-May			
15	M	11-May			
	W	13-May			
Final	Sunday	17-May	**Final Exam**: 2:00pm, Smith 130		